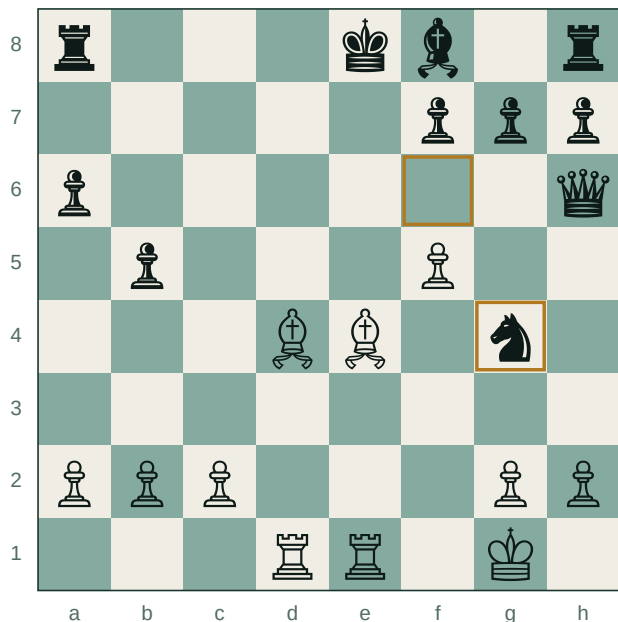


Double checks: White, move 19

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 18...Nxg4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19. Bc6+ Kd8 20. Bb6+ Kc8 21. Re8#

19.Bc6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From c6 it attacks king on e8 and rook on a8. Recorded reply: **19...Kd8**.

20.Bb6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the rook on d1 attacks the king on d8. Recorded reply: **20...Kc8**.

21.Re8# Mate: rook on e8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on c8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on e8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.